

Document Request Templates

Email structures for requesting transcripts, recommendation letters, and certificates - adapt these with your own details and tone.

1. Requesting Transcripts from Your School/University

- Your full name (as it appears on official records) and student/roll number
- Years of attendance and program/stream studied
- Exact document needed (transcript, mark sheet, certified copy) and how many copies
- Purpose: "for a student visa application to study in [country]"
- Your preferred delivery method and address, plus a reasonable deadline

2. Requesting a Recommendation Letter

- A polite, direct opening reminding them how they know you (course, project, work)
- The specific program and university you're applying to
- 2-3 concrete points you'd appreciate them mentioning (a project, a skill, a quality)
- The deadline, and an offer to provide a draft or your CV/SOP to help them write it
- A thank-you, and an offer to follow up in person if useful

3. Requesting a Duplicate Certificate (Lost/Damaged Original)

- Your full name, registration number, and year of completion
- A brief, honest explanation (lost, damaged, or never collected)
- Explicit request for a duplicate marked as such, with official seal
- Any fee you understand applies, and your willingness to pay it

General tone advice

Keep these emails short, specific, and polite. Institutions and referees respond faster to a request that clearly states what's needed and by when than to a long, vague message.